

NetHope Connectivity+ Grant — Round 2

Grant Application Form
SOS Children's Villages Palestine

Section 1: Project Overview

1. What is the title of your project?

Connected in Crisis: Building a Secure, Always-On Network for Child Protection in Gaza

2. Which Member organization is submitting the application?

SOS Children's Villages Palestine

3. What is your organization's address?

National Office, Manger St., Nazzal Building, Bethlehem, Palestine

4. Who is the point of contact for the grant?

Roni Hihi, ICT Manager Email: Roni.Hihi@sos-palestine.org

5. Are you applying with or on behalf of other organizations?

No. SOS Children's Villages Palestine is the sole applicant and will serve as both the Member Project Lead and implementing organization.

6. In what country will the grant be used?

Palestine — Gaza Strip

7. What is your proposed grant duration?

12 months

Note on Duration: While the Connectivity+ Grant typically supports projects within a 6-month window, SOS Palestine respectfully requests a 12-month implementation period due to the exceptional operational constraints specific to Gaza. The ongoing conflict has significantly disrupted supply chains, logistics, and contractor availability. Procurement of specialized ICT equipment — particularly routers, UPS units, and managed access points — involves extended lead times, complex import procedures, and limited availability of certified local vendors. Additionally, security conditions may require phased implementation to ensure staff safety during installation and training activities. A 12-month timeline ensures quality delivery, adequate staff training, and full documentation of lessons learned for sector-wide sharing. SOS

Palestine is committed to maintaining close communication with NetHope throughout implementation and will provide quarterly progress updates.

8. How much funding are you requesting?

USD \$25,000

Currency Info (as of May 6, 2026)	Rate (mid-market)	Grant Amount (USD)	Equivalent (NIS / ₪)
USD → NIS (Israeli New Shekel)	\$1 USD = ₪2.9352 NIS	\$25,000	₪73,380 NIS

Source: XE.com mid-market rate, May 6, 2026. Note: Actual rate at time of disbursement may vary. Exchange rate risk should be factored into budget planning.

Section 2: Project Description

9. Please introduce your project (max 300 words)

SOS Children's Villages Palestine has maintained an active emergency response presence in both Gaza and the West Bank throughout consecutive cycles of conflict and humanitarian crisis. Despite these efforts, persistent electricity outages, severely damaged physical infrastructure, and unreliable internet connectivity continue to undermine critical operations — limiting staff coordination, disrupting case management systems, and restricting children's access to remote learning, psychosocial support, and safe digital spaces.

"Connected in Crisis" directly addresses these barriers by establishing secure, uninterrupted Wi-Fi coverage and dependable power backup infrastructure at the SOS Gaza Camp in Khan Younis. The project will deliver cloud-managed Wi-Fi across the full camp footprint, DNS-filtered internet to ensure child-safe browsing, and an upgraded Uninterruptible Power Supply (UPS) system for the central ICT server — ensuring connectivity is maintained even during prolonged blackouts or network disruptions.

These upgrades will enable staff to sustain real-time coordination with the SOS National Office in Bethlehem, maintain continuity of digital child protection and case management services, and provide safe online environments for children and youth during emergencies. Two structured training workshops will build lasting local ICT capacity, supporting SOS Palestine’s localization objectives and ensuring the solution is independently managed by local staff long after project completion.

In total, the project will directly benefit approximately 240 children, youth, caregivers, and staff who depend on SOS services daily — transforming the SOS Gaza Camp into a digitally resilient, inclusive humanitarian environment and advancing SOS Palestine’s broader Digital Transformation and Emergency Preparedness Framework (2024–2026).

10. Please describe the proposed activities

The project will be implemented across five integrated components:

- **Power Resilience:** Procure and install a 3–5 kVA Uninterruptible Power Supply (UPS) with surge protection for the central ICT server room, ensuring continued operation of all digital systems during electricity cuts.
- **Wi-Fi Expansion:** Deploy 12 managed indoor/outdoor access points (Cisco Meraki or TP-Link Omada) to provide full-camp Wi-Fi coverage, including residential tents, learning spaces, child-friendly areas, and administrative offices.
- **Network Security & Digital Safety:** Configure segmented VLANs for staff and children, enable cloud monitoring, and activate DNSFilter or Cloudflare Gateway to ensure safe, age-appropriate internet access for children and youth.
- **Training & Capacity Building:** Deliver two structured training workshops for local SOS Gaza ICT staff and program leads on network management, cybersecurity fundamentals, and emergency communications protocols.
- **Testing, Documentation & Knowledge Sharing:** Conduct a live connectivity stress test, compile a lessons-learned report, and share the "Connected in Crisis" model with other SOS locations and NetHope Members.

Implementation will be led by SOS Palestine, with remote technical support from the National ICT team in Bethlehem. Local contractors in Gaza will assist with equipment installation, promoting localization. All hardware and licenses will be registered in the SOS ICT Asset Register.

11. How will this grant contribute to your organization's work and the broader sector?

This grant will significantly strengthen SOS Children's Villages Palestine's capacity to sustain uninterrupted operations during emergencies — reinforcing ICT infrastructure that underpins child protection, case management, family support, and remote education. By ensuring reliable access to Microsoft 365, Teams, SharePoint, and coordination platforms even during blackouts, the project directly enhances service continuity when it is most critically needed.

Beyond SOS Palestine's organizational impact, the integrated "Connectivity-as-Resilience" model provides a cost-effective, replicable framework for organizations operating in high-risk, infrastructure-degraded environments. SOS Palestine will actively engage NetHope working groups and MENA regional ICT networks to share operational insights and technical lessons, enabling peer organizations to adopt similar approaches.

Section 3: Beneficiaries & Targets

12. Who will benefit from your project?

Direct Beneficiaries:

- Children and youth residing in SOS Gaza Camp (~180–200 individuals) who will gain stable, safe access to digital learning platforms and psychosocial support services.
- SOS Gaza staff (~25–35 employees) who will use the network for case management, emergency coordination, and real-time reporting.

- Local ICT focal points and program leads who will receive hands-on training in network management, cybersecurity, and emergency communications.

Indirect Beneficiaries:

- SOS National Office in Bethlehem, gaining remote visibility and control over Gaza's connectivity infrastructure.
- Partner organizations and emergency responders in Gaza benefiting from improved inter-agency coordination.
- The broader humanitarian ICT community through knowledge-sharing of the "Connected in Crisis" model.

13-16. Project Targets

Target	Value
Number of organizations	1 — SOS Children's Villages Palestine
Number of people reached	~240 (children, youth, caregivers, and staff)
Number of countries	1 — Palestine (Gaza Strip)
Number of national geographic regions	1 — SOS Children's Village, Khan Younis, Gaza Strip

Section 4: Additional Information

17. Any additional information to support the application?

This project aligns directly with SOS Palestine's Digital Transformation and Emergency Preparedness Framework (2024-2026), and builds on existing partnerships with Cisco Meraki, Microsoft, and NetHope. All hardware will be procured through local Gazan and Palestinian suppliers wherever feasible, supporting the local economy. Ongoing maintenance responsibilities will be integrated into SOS Palestine's core ICT operational budget, ensuring long-term sustainability beyond the grant period. Upon project completion, SOS Palestine will present outcomes and the replicable "Connected in Crisis" framework at a NetHope Working Group session for the MENA region and global humanitarian ICT community.

Submitted by SOS Children's Villages Palestine | Contact: Roni Hihi, ICT Manager | Roni.Hihi@sos-palestine.org